David Morgan-Gumm

Data & AI Engineer

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PROFILE

I've spent eight years building data platforms, starting with SQL warehouses and more recently working on Azure and Microsoft Fabric. I was promoted three times at Oliver James and finished as Data Platform Manager, leading a team of six. I moved back to hands-on work at Brabners because AI is becoming so important to how applications are built, and I wanted to experience it properly as a developer before moving further into senior management. Outside work, I run the sql_squared data community and build Echelon, a web app for tabletop gaming groups.

SKILLS

Data: Microsoft Fabric, Azure Synapse, Azure Data Factory, Azure Data Explorer, SQL Server and Azure SQL, Power BI, Tamr, medallion architecture, dimensional modelling

Languages: SQL (T-SQL), Python, PySpark, KQL, TypeScript, C#

Cloud: Azure (Functions, Logic Apps, Key Vault), Google Cloud Platform (Cloud Run, Firebase Hosting)

DevOps: GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps pipelines, Bicep, Docker, automated testing

AI: Claude Code and agentic development, Microsoft Foundry, Azure AI Language

Apps and integration: React, Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL, REST and GraphQL APIs, Salesforce, SAP Business ByDesign

EXPERIENCE

Data & AI Engineer, Brabners, Manchester — Aug 2026 – Present

- Built and launched Central Intelligence Tools, a Next.js and TypeScript application that 400 to 500 people use to open new matters and set up what they need to work on them.
- Delivered a new analytical SQL data warehouse using a medallion architecture. It is now in production, takes data from two source systems and feeds a full Power BI reporting suite. The next steps are to add more of the firm's systems, then master data management and a move to Azure.
- Set up CI/CD pipelines and automated testing in GitHub Actions, infrastructure as code in Bicep, and branch protection with pull request policies.
- Introduced Claude Code and agentic development to a four-person development team as part of the firm's AI strategy. Every change must pass tests, CI checks and a pull request review before it is merged.

Oliver James, Manchester — **Feb 2021 – Jul 2026**

Data Platform Manager — Nov 2023 – Jul 2026

- Led a team of six data engineers and developers, including one manager, and owned the roadmap for data and development.
- Mentored two junior engineers through to promotion.
- Migrated the data platform from Azure Synapse to Microsoft Fabric (OneLake, Lakehouse, PySpark notebooks, Bicep). The move brought major improvements in data quality and master data management.
- Delivered master data management with Tamr on Fabric for 1 million+ person and company records. Duplication fell by 20–30%, and golden records went out to downstream systems through events and APIs.
- Built daily LinkedIn job-market analytics in Azure Data Explorer, using Azure AI Language to extract skills and industries from job postings for whitespace reporting on unmet talent demand.
- Introduced a development change board, a release plan shared with the business and tighter sprint ceremonies to protect planned work from ad-hoc requests.
- Managed external implementation partners on enterprise application suites and public-facing applications, and wrote the requirements for business-critical integrations.

Data Engineering Lead — Oct 2022 – Oct 2023

- Set up the DevOps function from scratch, using Azure DevOps YAML pipelines to move all software, data and AI resources from manual releases to fully automated deployment. Deployment time fell by 80%.
- Built an event-driven reporting suite that gave management statistics on calls from five countries within seconds. Later added AI summaries of call transcripts using Microsoft Foundry.
- Co-wrote the long-term data strategy with senior leadership, focused on embedding data in core business processes.

Senior Data Engineer — Oct 2021 – Sep 2022

- Designed and delivered a new Azure Synapse data platform (Data Lake Storage Gen2, Data Factory, dimensional models) used by 1,000+ people across 12+ countries.
- Worked with third-party consultancies to integrate the legacy finance systems with a new SAP Business ByDesign ERP. Automated validation and reconciliation kept data accuracy at 99.9%.
- Designed the Salesforce integration, using custom SOQL to delta-load sales activity into the data lake that became the basis for core business reporting.

SQL Developer Feb 2021 – Sep 2021

- Built a cloud-first SQL data warehouse during a period of rapid growth, reverse-engineering legacy systems so that key business logic was not lost.

SQL Developer & Software Tester, Evolution Recruitment, Warrington Jul 2018 – Feb 2021

- Extended the SQL data warehouse behind the in-house CRM.
- Worked on the business's first migration to an Azure data stack.
- Recognised by the business for improving the usability and reporting of its in-house software.

PROJECTS AND COMMUNITY

Founder, SQL Squared Ltd (alongside employment) 2024 – Present

- **Echelon** (echelon.sqlsquared.co.uk) is a live web app that replaces the spreadsheets that tabletop gaming groups use to run their Crusade campaigns. It has free and paid tiers and its own Discord community.

  Built in TypeScript using React, Express, PostgreSQL (Supabase) and Drizzle ORM, with Stripe for billing and Vitest for testing. Hosted on Google Cloud Platform using Cloud Run and Firebase Hosting. Develop it with Claude Code as a pair programmer, owning the architecture and reviewing every change myself.
- **sql_squared** (sqlsquared.co.uk) is a community for data and AI professionals, with technical articles, a YouTube channel and a podcast featuring industry practitioners.

Redgate Community Ambassador May 2025 – Present

- Provide feedback on Redgate's database DevOps tools, write about them and attend their events.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 2:1, University of Liverpool 2018

Level 5 Management and Leadership, Chartered Management Institute 2026

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), Microsoft 2019